20

GARMENT CONSTRUCTION AND COLOUR COMBINATION

20.1 INTRODUCTION

Colour combinations has a very important place in tailoring and also in the world of fashion. Our eye first travels to the kind of clothes worn by a person when we meet. But if someone asks us to describe what the other person was wearing, we readily reply - a blue suit or a green shirt, etc. Colour combination are also important in dress designing and can be used effectively to make a dress appealing and attractive.

20.2 OBJECTIVE

After reading this lesson, you will be able to :

- select a colour combination in accordance with the design of the garment;
- make garments appealing and attractive;
- explain the importance of colour combination in designing.

20.3 IMPORTANCE OF COLOUR COMBINATION

1. If a fabric has a good colour combination in its design, it will look good and even though it may be rough or inferior quality sometimes happen that we impulsively buy cloth from the market because it appears so attractive even though it may not be of good quality.

2. Increase in price - A good colour combination obviously leads to a very attractive fabric or garment it attracts us from a far. A good design and attractive colour combination leads to an increase in price.

3. When the price increases, the demand also increases because everyone wants to wear well designed attractive clothes. People think that only expensive clothes look good, hence the demand for these clothes goes up.

4. Good workmanship establishes a good reputation in the market. Customers are naturally attracted to new designs and good colour schemes.

In this way, colour schemes and colour contrasting play a big role in designing. We can create a variety of designs by using colour schemes. Colour schemes are very helpful in designing.

20.4 SELECTION OF COLOURS

While selecting colours we have to consider which colours will suit an individual. For this, the following points should be borne in mind.

i) Colour of hair, eyes and complexion

ii) Age

iii) Personality

iv) Profession and level

Characteristics of Colours

1. Red colour

This is a very warm and active colour. It gives the feeling of advancement. It signifies beauty and happiness. It is generally used in children's garment and in toys.

2. Yellow colour

It is a bright warm colour signifying happiness and lightness. By nature it is a hot colour.

3. Purple colour

This is a rich but cool colour. It signifies strength.

4. Red-purple colour

It is a combination of warm and cool colour.

5. Green colour

It is a colour which can easily be combined with other colours. It is a cool colour which reflects inner peace.

6. Orange colour

It is a very strong colour and is generally not used. It signifies happiness and festive spirit.

Suitability of Colours

1. Brunette

People with black hair, black eyes and dusky complexion should avoid the use of yellow and purple indicators. They should also avoid wearing white.

2. Blonde

People with golden hair, blue eyes and fair complexion should avoid wearing yellow, deep red, red-purple and brown colours. They should also avoid the use of other bright colours.

3. Auburn

Persons having red hair, blue eyes and a fair complexion should avoid the use of red, orange, yellow, red-purple, brown, pink colours and prints.

4. Hazel

People with grey hair, brown or blue eyes and fair complexion should avoid the use of grey, purple and other complementary bright colours.

20.5 INFLUENCE OF COLOUR AND DESIGN ON PERSONALITY

1. Plain colour make a person appear slimmer.
2. Vertical stripes gives an appearance of height.
3. Horizontal stripes make a person appear short.
4. Vertical, large floral prints make a person look active.
5. Beautiful prints designs make a person appear beautiful.

Practical application

If one wants a person to look younger, cool, dark colours should be used. Light colours make a person look older. Dark colours lend youthfulness to a personality.

Colours according to seasons

Effect of temperature, effect of light colours, effect of extreme temperature.

White - white colour reflects light colours

Black - absorbs light colours.

Light colours are cooler and more comfortable to wear in summers when temperatures are high. This is because dark colours absorb light. It also matches the skin colour.

On the other hand, white reflects light colours and enhances the colour scheme and also helps in changing it. In this way, you have seen how colour harmony and contrasting are important in designing. They help us in making the garments beautiful and attractive.

20.6 WHAT HAVE YOU LEARNT

In this lesson you have learnt about the importance of colour schemes in designing.

DO AND SEE

Apply the use of colour schemes in designing.

20.7 TERMINAL EXERCISE

1. Explain in detail the importance of colour schemes and the characteristics of colour in designing.